JAMES MITCHELL

Forward Deployed Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a Forward Deployed Engineer with 5 years of experience deploying and maintaining infrastructure across remote and austere environments. I have a practical approach to problem-solving, comfortable working independently on complex systems while maintaining reliable communication with distributed teams. My background spans cloud infrastructure, network operations, and on-site technical support, with a particular strength in troubleshooting production issues under pressure and implementing solutions that actually stick.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud Platforms: AWS, Azure, Google Cloud Platform

Infrastructure as Code: Terraform, CloudFormation, Ansible

Containerization: Docker, Kubernetes, Docker Swarm

Programming Languages: Python, Bash, Go, JavaScript

Networking: TCP/IP, VPN configuration, DNS, routing, firewalls

Monitoring and Logging: Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack, Datadog

Databases: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis

CI/CD: Jenkins, GitLab CI, GitHub Actions

Version Control: Git, GitHub, GitLab

Operating Systems: Linux (RHEL, Ubuntu), Windows Server

Tools: Nginx, Apache, HAProxy, Consul

WORK EXPERIENCE

Forward Deployed Engineer

Vortex Solutions Ltd

vortex-solutions.io

Kandahar, Afghanistan

Mar 2022 - Present

Deployed and maintained cloud infrastructure supporting military communications across 12 forward operating bases with zero unplanned downtime over 18 months

Provided 24/7 technical support to field teams, resolving network and server issues remotely and through on-site visits with average resolution time of 2 hours

Implemented automated monitoring and alerting system using Prometheus and Grafana that reduced incident response time by 40 percent

Trained local IT staff on infrastructure management and troubleshooting, creating documentation in both English and local languages

Senior Infrastructure Technician

Alpine Networks Co

alpine-networks.co.uk

London, United Kingdom

Jun 2020 - Feb 2022

Designed and deployed Kubernetes clusters for 8 enterprise clients, managing containerized applications and reducing infrastructure costs by average 35 percent per deployment

Established automated backup and disaster recovery procedures using Terraform, reducing recovery time objective from 8 hours to 15 minutes

Managed on-site deployments for clients requiring hands-on infrastructure setup, traveling to 6 European locations annually

Developed Python automation scripts that reduced manual server configuration time from 4 hours to 20 minutes per deployment

Junior Systems Engineer

TechCore Infrastructure

techcore.net

Birmingham, United Kingdom

Jul 2019 - May 2020

Supported production Linux and Windows Server environments for 20 internal and external clients, maintaining 99.5 percent uptime across all systems

Assisted with AWS cloud migration projects, moving 15 legacy applications from on-premises data centers to EC2 instances and RDS databases

Documented network architecture and created runbooks for common operational tasks, improving team efficiency and reducing onboarding time for new staff

Monitored system performance using ELK Stack and responded to alerts, implementing fixes for issues ranging from disk space to memory leaks

EDUCATION

BSc Computer Science

University of Birmingham

Birmingham, United Kingdom

2015 - 2019

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect Associate

Kubernetes Application Developer Certification

CompTIA Security Plus

PUBLIC REPOSITORIES

jmitchell-eng/terraform-aws-deployment - Terraform modules for deploying secure VPC infrastructure on AWS with auto-scaling and load balancing

jmitchell-eng/k8s-monitoring-stack - Complete Prometheus and Grafana setup for Kubernetes cluster monitoring with custom dashboards

jmitchell-eng/network-diagnostics-tool - Python utility for automated network troubleshooting and connectivity testing across distributed sites

jmitchell-eng/ansible-hardening - Ansible playbooks for security hardening of Linux servers across multiple distributions